

YOU SAID, "IT IS USELESS TO SERVE GOD"

THE REASON WHY YOUR SPIRITUAL EFFORTS
YEILD NO RESULTS

MUNASHE SOKA



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"It Is Useless To Serve God."

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Chapter 1

The Pharisee and the Tax Collector

In this chapter, I shall talk about the dangers of self righteousness. It is only when you have developed pride in your own goodness that the lessons in this chapter become applicable to you.

Have you ever noticed that the most devoted and dedicated Christians are the ones whom God seem not to bless?

In most churches when God begins to move in people's lives it seems like He normally skips over the most committed Christians. In most healing services and revivals, I have attended, I have noted that the less devoted, or almost certainly, the habitual sinning Christians and even unbelievers; are the ones who receive instant healing at just the laying on of the hands of a preacher.

The most zealous, 'holy' and evil shunning saints are normally slow to receive healing and in some cases, if not most of the time, they may not even receive any healing. They will spend the rest of their lives, and die while praying and fasting for the healing that never comes.

It normally appears as if most prayers of the less committed Christians are quick to be answered than those of the most pious saints. In church as I grew up, I would see that many testimonies of the good that God is doing in people's lives - promotions at work, the obtaining of scholarships, successful purchase of a new stand or house, breakthroughs in business, etc. came from the families of the less holy Christians; the type of people you would say, "How can God bless this brother or sister who is not even so committed to the things of God?" But God seemed to be so good to them.

While typical sinning Christians don't even need to fast and pray a lot, the holy and most religious Christians spend longer

periods of time fasting and praying for things and may not even receive answers sometimes, or may receive but after a longer period.

There are many examples I can give and you might probably have your own. All this disturbed me just as it disturbs any devoted Christian. As a result, I began to seek answers from God as to why He seems to be ignoring His good and righteous children who call upon Him day and night. As years went by, as I continued to prayerfully study the word of God concerning this, God began to unveil some truths in the word of God which liberated and provided me with the answers.

I began to understand the grace of God. Ephesians 2:8 was revealed to me. I got surprised that irrespective of the simplicity of the grace message on Ephesians 2:8, not all Christians believe in it. And they don't even want to accept this simple message that bears all their answers; —so sad.

God Moves By His Grace and Love

Ephesians 2 : 8 (NKJV)

*For by grace you have been saved
through faith, and that not of yourselves;
it is the gift of God,*

Some years when I hadn't yet understood the meaning of this scripture, I used to believe, like many devoted Christians, that it is what we do that moves God to work in our lives. A lot of Christians think like this; they think that because of their good and the righteous works they do, God should touch their lives and bless them. They feel like God is bound to work in their lives because they are holy.

Most Christians believe in their good 'religious' works, and in their much praying and fasting or their financial contribution to church, more than they believe in the mediatory and finished work of Christ on the cross. That is the bad side of a committed Christian life; it removes the power of the cross from your life and makes the grace of God as nothing special.

I will explain.

Let me say this: It is only by His grace and His love that God moves towards us. He is never moved by your religious works. The only human work which truly moved God towards all of us was that which Jesus Christ did on the cross. Through Jesus, God sent His blessings on us, He brought salvation to us and by Christ's stripes God sent healing to us. He moved by grace because of Christ's work and there is not any human work that He is going to respond to unless your work is entirely based on Jesus Christ's work. What a huge statement I have just said!

The only mistake that is normally made by the most devoted Christians is that they tend to depend and/or develop confidence in their good works than they depend on Jesus Christ. As they look at how righteous and committed they are, they somehow ignore Jesus' mediatory work and think they can earn God's approval because of their good works before Him. They develop pride and think

they are even more holy than Jesus himself, so to say. Self-righteousness has the power to take you to these extremes, and a lot of holy saints are now living on these extremes and no fruit is now coming from their lives.

I think what I am saying can best be explained by a parable which Jesus once spoke to the people of His day about the Pharisee (the most devoted saint) and the Tax Collector (a sinning person) who went up to the temple to pray one day. I want you to read this passage of scripture below.

The Pharisee and the Tax Collector

Luke 18:10-14 (ESV)

Two men went up into the temple to pray, one a Pharisee and the other a tax collector. The Pharisee, standing by himself, prayed thus: 'God, I thank you that I am not like other men, extortioners, unjust, adulterers, or even

like this tax collector. I fast twice a week; I give tithes of all that I get.'
But the tax collector, standing far off, would not even lift up his eyes to heaven, but beat his breast, saying, 'God, be merciful to me, a sinner!' I tell you, this man went down to his house justified, rather than the other. For everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, but the one who humbles himself will be exalted."

Have you seen it? God loves to see our prayers answered as long as we understand His grace, mercy and love towards us. The Pharisee in that story did not understand the grace and love of God. He thought that a person must do something good first before God answers his prayers and that God is moved by men's holiness. But God is not like that. God loves to answer our prayers and bless our lives simply because He loves us and is gracious to us. The Pharisee was never answered even though he used to fast and

pray so much, pay his tithes and live a holy life. This sounds familiar to what is happening to a lot of 'holy' Christians in church today.

In fact, to be more direct with you, let me mention this right now: everything that we need from God in this life, and almost all the things we pray for, have all been provided to us in Christ Jesus by God's grace. All that you need from God was already sent down to us by His grace through the death, burial and resurrection of Christ. We do not need to move God to do anything else because He moved already.

We only need to come to Him in Faith and freely receive all that we need. Faith is the only work we need to do in order to see God's blessings in our lives. I am talking about true faith here. True faith is always based on Jesus Christ's work. Faith is work that is based on God's grace.

It was by His love and grace that He made all spiritual blessings available to us in Christ and He did that while we were

still sinners without any good work we had done yet. We do not live right in order to be blessed because we are already blessed. We only live right because we are children of a righteous God and living right is our new nature in Christ. Living right, because we know we have been given the righteousness of Christ, is a work of faith that is based on Christ. Righteous works are good, as long as they are works of faith, i.e. works that are inspired by your faith in God's grace; whether it be giving to the poor, walking in love or giving financially to church.

That is who we are, the salt of the earth. We live right because we were born righteous in Christ. A dog barks because that is its nature. It was born a dog. Sin is not part of a new creature in Christ Jesus. When you were born again, you were born to a life that contains no sin in it. You were born to a life of righteousness. You were born righteous and you should not struggle to live right because that is your new nature. We do not live right in order

to make God bless us. If that is your motive, you will be frustrated along the way. We don't move God by our works. He moved already in Christ.

God Is Moved By His Love

The bible says on John 3:16 that God loved the world to the extent that He gave His only begotten Son to die for us. The question is, when God loved everyone in this world, what good thing was it that was done by the people of this world that made God love us? The answer is, there is nothing good we had done for Him to love us. God simply loved us because He loves us and that is the reason why He loves to bless us and see our prayers answered. Let this stick with you.

God looked at the people and saw that many of them were living their lives for Satan and that at the end, those people would be destroyed in hell together with Satan. God did not want that to happen to

people. He did not want to see the people He loves go to hell together with the devil simply because they were living for the devil and had become his prisoners. God had to send His only Son to die for them in order that He rescue them from the bondage of Satan. God was moved by His love, mercy and compassion towards us while we were still sinners.

God loves you and He wants the best for your life. Your good works are not the reason why God should love you. We only do good works simply because we want to love God in return and that we do not want to serve Satan. God loves everyone regardless of what we have done or did not do. God simply loves us.

But the religious Pharisee in that story, like many dedicated Christians today, did not understand the love of God. He thought that God hated the tax collector because he was a sinner, and that God should love him because he was a righteous man.

No! God is not like that. He loves

everyone and a lot of 'holy' believers have not yet understood the love of God. We do not live holy lives because we want God to love or bless us. We only live holy lives because we want to love God back and show others in the world the love of God through our lives. If you love God, you will live for Him and at the same time you will love the people He loves. You will not do anything bad to harm other people because you are so full of the love of God. When we were born again, we were born with the nature of love within us. We love because we are children of a loving God. It must be easy for you to love God and all the other people in the world. Love is your nature.

But if you still struggle to love automatically then it might mean that you are not truly born again. Whatever you do for God must be a result of the love of God in you. If not, then you have a wrong motive in serving God or you are not yet born again.

1 John 4:7 (NKJV)

Beloved, let us love one another, for love is from God, and whoever loves has been born of God and knows God.

If you know that you are born again but you have not been living and walking in love it means you didn't know the word of God about who you are. Now that you know, simply use your faith and show out of your spirit the love of God. It is possible for a truly born again Christian to struggle to live in righteousness if that person is not enlightened by the word of God or when that person has not yet grown spiritually in the knowledge of who they are in Christ. But, if after you have been enlightened like this, and try to live in righteousness and keep on struggling then I doubt if you were truly born again in the first place.

Embrace the Mercy and Grace of God

Living a good and holy life is like

saying to God, "I love you too and I want to live for you." It has nothing to do with making Him bless us because we are so, so good and righteous. We end up developing pride in our holiness and ignore the fact that it is Jesus Christ who makes us holy (a subject for another chapter). You read about the story of the Pharisee and the tax collector. The Pharisee was prideful when he approached God because he thought he should be accepted for his goodness.

The less evil shunning people (and even the less devoted and sinning believers like the tax collector), on the other hand, are not like that when they approach God. Because they have nothing on their own to boast before God, they realize their unworthiness and quickly throw themselves on the mercy and grace of God who can forgive them. They know they are living in sin and they have to depend completely on the mercy of God.

They come before God with humility and receive the grace of God through Jesus

Christ. Without realizing it, they end up acting as if they know that God loves them regardless of their good works or sins and at the end they come back with testimonies. They approach God in faith towards His grace, mercy and love. Such kind of faith in God's love is very powerful. That is childlike faith and such simple faith is very powerful and fruitful. It enables you to receive God's blessings.

These ones, who come before God believing in His mercy, tend to completely and entirely commit their dependence on Jesus Christ's righteousness; not their own, since they don't have any. Because of this, they are quick to receive from God as they are the ones who approach God out of true and pure faith that is grounded on the work of Christ alone. It is faith that works. Even if the more holy saints come before God with faith towards His grace, they will receive from Him. But, as it is in reality, it is hard for those who trust in their goodness to relate with God based only on grace because they will feel like they

would have wasted their efforts in trying to live right if it is only by grace that they get anything from God. That is so funny, but I understand them because I was once like many of them.

Before you read any further, I want you to know that I am NOT supporting sin or encouraging those believers who are living in sin to keep sinning and end up abusing the grace of God. I am just stressing my point that we need to keep trusting the grace and love of God in our lives even as we live righteously.

You must live a holy life and not go on indulging in sin, but as you live a holy life, do not let your holiness pull your sight away from the grace of God through Jesus Christ. If you are living in sin, you are not doing yourself any good because sin will surely destroy your life. Sin is powerful enough to do that. We are children of God. We are children of Light. We are the salt of the earth. We must live holy lives and separated from the world because that is who we are. That is how we reign in life.

We reign with the righteousness of Christ in us.

While it is very important to do good works, religious works can only turn out bad and unfruitful if you begin let them remove your spiritual gaze away from Christ. Continue doing good works because you are God's child but don't ever depend on them or make them think you are now closer to God's heart than all the people. God loves everyone and even those who are still living in sin and those who have not yet made a decision to receive Jesus Christ are loved dearly by God.

God relates with us through grace; the grace He showed through Christ. Believe in Him and surrender your all.

Now, I know I have said some things in this chapter which require much explanation. I want to talk, in the next chapter about the righteousness of Jesus versus our own righteousness. God never wanted us to come before Him with our own righteousness or goodness. Your own

goodness stinks before God. He turns away when you approach Him with your own righteousness because they look like a polluted garment before Him.

Isaiah 64:6 (ESV)

We have all become like one who is unclean, and all our righteous deeds are like a polluted garment. We all fade like a leaf, and our iniquities, like the wind, take us away.

Chapter 2

You Said, "It Is Useless to Serve God."

Malachi 3 : 14 (NKJV)

*You have said, 'It is useless to serve God;
What profit is it that we have kept His
ordinance, And that we have walked as
mourners Before the Lord of hosts?*

During the days of the prophet Malachi, the Jews had become bitter against God. They had followed most of God's commandments; they had given their tithes and offerings; they had contributed financially and with their strengths to the building of God's temple; and they had even engaged in much fasting and prayer, looking miserable before God just so that God could see all this and bless their lives.

Nevertheless, they did not see any

profit or any blessing of God in their lives as a result of their much devotion and piety. They began to complain against God just as many people today complain and grumble against God. They said, "it is useless to serve God." If you have become angry against God to the extent of saying without fear that serving God is useless, then something is very wrong with your understanding of God and your Christianity. You have become very prideful and pompous. The Jews actually went on to say, "What profit is it that we have kept God's ordinance?"

You see, these people served God because they were looking for PROFIT. All they wanted was to enrich their lives and that was all. When you would see these people in the temple praying or working to clean the house of God; when you would see them sitting in synagogues listening to the preaching of God's word; and when you would see them giving money to the poor or giving offerings and tithes to the priests; as well as attending all the feasts

(conferences) at the temple, you would think that these religious people loved God with all their hearts.

But that was not true. There was no love for God in their hearts. They were just doing godly acts so that when God sees their devotion, He could bless them. All they wanted was to MAKE PROFIT by being godly. They did not love God at all. They loved what they could benefit from God and that was all they thought was the purpose of serving God.

In this life, there are young beautiful women who marry some old, bulky and ugly rich men just for the sake of their money. Have you ever seen this? Some people say that when a man has got money, beautiful women will love him. Do you think he is truly loved or it is because of his money? How many men have been dumped by their young beautiful loving women the moment they got broke?

God feels the same with you. God is looking for a true relationship and communion with you. He is looking for

true love between you and Him. He loved you. He went to the extent of sacrificing His only Son so that He can have you. Imagine such kind of love and when you come to Him, all you want are only His blessings and breakthroughs in your life and that's all. You don't care about Him.

I have seen so many people who think that going to church is only for the purpose of God blessing our lives and solving our problems. People have so desired this to such an extent that we preachers are moved to want to address all their problems and preach as if breakthroughs, blessings and the solving of problems is all God wants to do in their lives.

You need to change your motive in serving God before all your efforts fail to work and you end up saying, "It is useless to serve God." God's blessings are available to us in Christ Jesus; and we can get them anytime because we are heirs of God. They are our inheritance in Christ.

However, it is easy to appropriate all these riches in Christ when our only focus

in serving God is just so that we love Him and love what He loves. This is because when you understand the grace of God and His love, that is the only moment when you have true faith and that faith is a receiver of God's promises. Faith is provoked to work when we understand the grace and love of God.

If loving God becomes your only motive in serving God, you will see how easily all these things (the blessings) will be added to you. Faith to receive all these will just be so easy with you. God does not want His children to go on in life broke and sick; but even if this is true, it is not the only reason why we should follow God. We follow God because we have come to know the depths of His love and grace.

Don't get me wrong here. I know there is so much preaching on prosperity, breakthroughs and blessings and you may end up thinking that prosperity is the only reason for being a Christian. The preaching of prosperity is not bad at all (but some extremes of this prosperity gospel I think

are bad. The extremes are when that gospel begins to make people covetous, and not content with what they have. That level where believers begin to think that money is a measure of godliness, and begin to compete to be the richest. That level where believers can even get to the point of sinning against God, being corrupt, and even stealing just so that they get money. And that level where we begin to want to bribe God with our money to get rich; where we think God's blessings can be bought by large sums of offerings or 'seeds'. I know how bad this kind gospel has been presented; and how it is promoting greed.)

But, prosperity gospel, where we just tell people that it is God's for us to not go on in life struggling. Jesus said your heavenly father knows that you need food and clothing. The whole bible preaches prosperity. Moses himself preached prosperity when he was promising the land flowing with milk and honey. God wants His children to prosper and as

preachers we must tell people that God wants them to prosper and be in health.

Jesus Himself preached the good news to the poor and 'breakthroughs' out of prison to those who were bound in chains of the devil. The preaching of prosperity is very good. But, my point here is that we must not think prosperity is the only reason we come to church. As we preach prosperity and pursue it, let us not ignore that to love God is the real reason why we serve Him. When you love God you will love His Kingdom and work here on earth. You will then use your money towards advancing His Kingdom and proclaiming His heart to the world. Without money you may struggle to show God's heart to the world.

We aim to prosper because that is the best way we can serve God. You cannot give to the poor and show them the love of God if you do not have the money. We cannot build churches, build orphanages, bless our pastors, change our communities for God if we do not have money. We use

money to serve God. Our aim should be to love and serve God as we prosper. We love God because He first loved us.

God Loves You Just As You Are

Romans 5:8 (ESV)

but God shows his love for us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us.

The bible says that He loved us while we were yet sinners. While we were still filthy with sin; and while you are still living in adultery God loves you. While you are still murdering people and stealing their hard earned money, God loves you. While you are still in love with another woman's husband and while you are still prostituting, God loves you. While you are still selling illegal drugs and abusing them in your consumption of them, God loves you.

God's love is unconditional. He cannot

say, "I will love you and bless you only when you are living a life of holiness." Yes God wants us to live a life of holiness before Him. He wants you to repent of your sins and serve Him. But even if you do not serve Him. Even if you are not living holy, He still loves you and wants the best for you. His love is unconditional. He loves both the righteous and the sinner. He loves both those who are Christians and those who are not.

When you repent of your sins you are doing yourself a favour because that is when you begin to appropriate and live in the love of God. You make God's love effective in your life when you come and surrender your life to God. If you do not respond to God's love, then you will fail to see it working in your life because you have not received it by faith. God does not force Himself on anyone. He wants you to cooperate with Him first.

Do you know that all those sinners who die and go to hell are still loved by God? God loved them while they lived in sin on

the earth, rejecting Jesus, and they eventually died and went to hell. If you do not repent, you can still be loved by God and still go to hell forever. Repentance does good to you than to God. It helps you not God. God looks at the people in hell right now and probably says, "I loved them until the day they died. Even until now, I love them but there is nothing I can do for them now. They had their opportunity to repent while still alive."

Come to Jesus while there is still time. When you are in hell, that is the end of all these opportunities and chances God is giving you to come to Him. God will not be able to rescue you the very moment you die and go to hell. He will only love you but do nothing to rescue you; and that will be the case with you and God forever as you struggle with the pains of hell.

What Can You Do With God's Love?

His blessings are available to all of us and they are not even conditional because they are part of His love. Healing, divine health and prosperity are part of His love for us. The bible says that by His (Jesus') stripes we are healed (1 Peter 2:24). He brought healing to us while we were still sinners. He died so that the blessing of Abraham might come on everyone in the world. He did that while we were still sinners.

The question is, "What can you do because of His love for you?" God is grieved, and it gives Him pain to see that the people He is loving unconditionally are not loving Him back the same way. They only love to serve God if they are told that God will bless them. They only come to Him when they are told that God will make them enter heaven where their lives will be good. They only give their tithes and offering when they are told that God will open the windows of heaven and make them rich. They only repent of their sins simply because they fear going to hell

if they do not. They are only concerned about what they can gain or benefit from following Jesus.

You give to poor beggars on the street simply because you want God to bless you or you think He will make you enter heaven because of that. You only serve God simply because of what you can benefit from Him.

There are people who have become pastors, evangelists and preachers simply because they fear that if they do not preach God will punish them. They do not preach because they love God, but because they fear for their lives.

Today, many people have stopped giving tithes and offerings to God because they say that they were just wasting their money and no profit was coming out of it. They did not know that they were supposed to give because they love God. That money helps pastors and churches to keep preaching the gospel and bringing many people to Jesus. Do you not love that? Would you just give financially for

the sake of the lost in the world and those who need the ministry of Pastors and of the church in their lives? Don't you love them whom God loves? Does not God's love burn within you?

If your motive for giving and serving in church is only so that many people come to know God, grow in Christ, get saved, shown the love of God through our giving and come to Jesus, then you are doing it right; God's desire is now your desire. You will definitely see God's blessings in your life even if they are not your focus. God's blessings are a package that follows whoever loves both God and what God loves. You cannot avoid them if you truly serve God and give with pure motives. They are abundant in Christ and only those who pursue God out of pure love will discover all the riches that are found in Christ. They are always there for us as God's children.

But if you serve God only so that you can be blessed and enrich your pocket, you are not loving God and the lost people in

the world. You are loving yourself and not focusing on Christ. Your selfish motives are blinding your eyes to the riches that are in Christ and you will fail to get them because you will never see where they are located. Only when your focus is on Christ alone, eventually you will discover the abundance of these blessings.

That is the reason why you are not seeing God's blessing in your life. You are not living in the grace of God where blessings are abundantly available. Love Jesus with all your heart.

Colossians 3:1-3 (ESV)

If then you have been raised with Christ, seek the things that are above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God. Set your minds on things that are above, not on things that are on earth. For you have died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God.

God blesses people who give. It is true. But those who have got their minds

focused on loving God and His people, and on seeing God's desire accomplished on earth. Such kind of people will have blessings follow them. They have understood the love and grace of God. They know blessings are freely available to everyone in Christ and they do not need to try and make God bless them because such blessings are part of God's love for us. They come automatically to those who submit themselves under the grace of God through Jesus Christ.

However, there are not many Christians who understand the grace of God to this extent. It is so sad. They think it is all about their religious works that God should bless them. Such thinking blinds your heart and your mind to the true nature of God.

Chapter 3

Not Your Righteousness

Philippians 3:8-9 (ESV)

Indeed, I count everything as loss because of the surpassing worth of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord. For his sake I have suffered the loss of all things and count them as rubbish, in order that I may gain Christ and be found in him, not having a righteousness of my own that comes from the law, but that which comes through faith in Christ, the righteousness from God that depends on faith

When you hear about Jesus Christ's death, what do you really think it means? How important is Christ's death to you? Do you know the depth of the meaning of Jesus' coming to this earth and dying for the world? If you knew, you would throw

yourself instantly into the hands of the loving God.

Have you ever heard about the Ten Commandments? Are you keeping them? Do you feel like you are a holy person in the eyes of God right now? Do you feel like if you die you will go to heaven right away? Are you a good person? Are you a holy person? Have you ever told a lie in your life? Have you ever stolen anything? Do you always think the right and good thoughts always? Have you ever committed adultery or any sin? Do you have someone you hate? Are you a holy person? Have you ever lusted after a woman or a man in your heart and imagined unholy thoughts in your mind?

If you are not guilty of any of the above then wow, you are the most holy person I have ever met. But if you feel and know that you committed many of the above sins; and even more than the mentioned sins; and you feel you are guilty before God then you need mercy from God.

You might say, "I have also done a lot of other good works." Yes, everyone else has, but according to God's standards of holiness all our righteous deeds are like a polluted garment (Isaiah 64:6). God wants you to be only and strictly 100% holy and not 99% holy. He doesn't want even a single speck of sin. Even if you have done 98% good and righteous deeds, the other 2% of the times that you have sinned makes you to look like a polluted garment before Him. To God you are just a terrible sinner like any murderer you know. God wants you to be extremely pure and clean without any apologies.

James 2:10 (ESV)

For whoever keeps the whole law but fails in one point has become guilty of all of it.

Do you think you can attain God's standards? I do not think so. On Philippians 3:8 which I have put at the beginning of this chapter, Paul says that he is now counting all his righteous deeds and

good works in obeying the commandments (or the law) as if they are all rubbish because he has now come to know Jesus. He used to feel like he was the most holy person before God simply because he did a lot of good works. But now that he has come to know Christ, he now counts all his goodness as rubbish just so that he could gain the righteousness that is found in Christ. He knew that he was headed to hell regardless of the many righteous deeds he did. How bad religion can be if God's grace does not come to the rescue.

God's Righteousness.

Matthew 6 : 33 (NKJV)

But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things shall be added to you.

This is one scripture that is most preached about. But I feel people have not seen much about this scripture. Jesus said

you should seek first God's Kingdom and 'His righteousness' and then all these blessings you want from God will simply be added to you.

Now, the part I want you focus your attention on is the part where Jesus said, "....and His righteousness." You must seek first the righteousness of God, not your righteousness. We try to please God with our own good works. We think our own good works and holiness are all that God wants from us. No! God is not interested in your own goodness. He wants you to have His righteousness and holiness which comes by faith in Jesus Christ.

When Jesus died, He was dying for the sins of everyone in the world. He was dying in your place. It was you who was supposed to die for your sins, but Jesus took all your sins and stood in your place and then He died. God has said that all sinners in the world were not supposed to live. They were supposed to die and go to hell.

Romans 6 : 23 (NKJV)

For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.

Jesus said to God, His Father, something like, "I want you to punish me in place of all the sinners in the world. I want to die for them just so that they would not die and go to hell for their sins."

When Jesus died for our sins, He paid our debt with God and God chose to forgive the sins of everyone in the world. When Jesus rose from the dead, He was now rising with a brand new life; the kind of life that no longer had the sins of the world in it. He rose again from the dead without sin because he had cast all the sins far away and dealt with them once and for all. This meant that your sins, and all the dirty things you have done, were thrown away very far from the eyes of God and He will never remember or even come close to them. They are removed forever by the blood of Christ.

Psalms 103 : 12 (NKJV)

*As far as the east is from the west, So far
has He removed our transgressions from
us.*

Our transgressions, that is, our sins and our breaking of God's laws, have been removed from us far away that they will never find us again; and God will never impute them on us again. Jesus rose from the dead with new life that He wanted everyone to have. This new life is the very life of God himself. It contains God's own righteousness and holiness which is 100% holy.

The moment you come to Jesus by faith and ask Him to come in your life, you are getting the life of God in you. You are putting on God's righteousness.

Receiving and accepting Jesus in your life means you are connecting yourself to the death of Christ. You are saying to God, "Include me among all the people that Jesus died for and give me the new life of

righteousness that Jesus rose from the dead with?

It is only the life of God that you need. The life that you have right now must be REPLACED by the life of God. The moment you open your mouth and ask Jesus to come in your heart, the Holy Spirit of God comes in your life and puts the life of God in you. You become holy and righteous before God with His own righteousness.

There are so many people who call themselves Christians and they have never at any one day given their lives to Jesus. They only joined a church. They just thought that going to church and doing good is all that God wants. The very first thing God wants from you is that you repent and ask Jesus to come into your life and replace your life with God's kind of life, thereby obtaining God's righteousness in you. Only when you receive the life of God are you a child of God. Otherwise you will one day find yourself in hell fire and wonder how you got there when you had

been a church member. You need to be born again into the true family of God.

God's Love Is the Perfect Remedy **For You**

1 John 4:10 (ESV)

In this is love, not that we have loved God but that he loved us and sent his Son to be the propitiation for our sins.

The moment God's kind of life enters into you, that is when you shall begin to understand the love of God for your life. Some people are angry against God right now. They think God is very wicked and unfair. They think He is the one responsible for killing their close relatives. I have met people who said, "If God loves me then why did He kill my mother?" , "Why did He send sickness to punish my dad or my uncle?" , "Why does He send all these tsunamis in the world?"

You say all such things because you

have not yet tasted God's love. God is not responsible for all those things. Evil came to exist on this earth because Adam gave up his right and power over this earth to Satan the day he disobeyed God. Remember that God gave all the power and dominion over this earth to Adam (to mankind) on Genesis 1:26, but that man, Adam and his wife, sold their power over this earth to Satan when they were tricked by him.

God had always had limited control over this earth even during the reign of Adam over this earth. Even until today, God still has limited control over this earth because He gave it to mankind to rule but Adam, God's man, gave place to the devil. It is Satan who is ruling this earth (see 2 Corinthians 4:4) because Adam gave him his God given power and allowed evil to reign on earth, including sickness, pain and death. However, when Jesus came to die for us He came to restore to us the power and authority that Adam used to have. Anyone who comes to believe in

Jesus and receives the life of God is automatically given the same power that Adam had; the power to rule over this earth and enforce God's will on earth in spite of the presence and influences of Satan on this earth. This is the power we have in Christ that we can use to stop the working of the devil in our lives and even in the lives of those around us, if they permit us.

Satan, however, is still ruling over this earth and will continue to do so until the end of this world when God shall put him into the lake of fire. Everyone who is not a Christian, who does not have the life of God in them, is being ruled by Satan right now. Even other Christians, who have not known much about how to use their God given authority and rights in Christ, are still being ruled by Satan. Any area of your life where you are not walking in obedience to God or where you have less knowledge of God, that is the area the devil takes advantage of in our lives. Satan is the cause of the evil you see in this world. He

works through the people he is ruling and cause them to do evil in this world.

If this book was a book entirely on the sovereignty of God, I would have talked and explained deeper on this subject about the cause for the evil in the world and the reason why God allows death and sickness on this earth. At least, I have given you a little bit of a hint.

God is not responsible for all this evil, the death, the suffering and even the sicknesses in the world. In fact, some of the sicknesses and diseases in the world are man made by the people who follow Satan. God is the God of love. He is love.

He does not bring evil to us and He wishes that all people come to Him and live for Him just so that His good will can be accomplished on earth. God's rulership on earth is only limited to the space that people can give to Him in their lives. If only the world can come to surrender their lives to God, we would witness a perfect and good world.

Nevertheless, it is not everyone who

loves to obey God and become a born again Christian. Many people just hate God and find no pleasure in Him. They have not yet known His love for them. They just don't love God.

A time in the future when Satan shall be thrown in hell, Jesus Christ alone shall begin to rule this world and that is when you shall see the perfect beauty of this world. Unfortunately, those who have not repented and given their lives to Jesus will not be able to see the perfect government of Jesus (and his church) in that future time as they will be in hell with Satan. You need to come to Christ today. You need to repent while there is still time. Now is the day of salvation.

Only until God's life and love enters into you, you remain in darkness and in the chains of Satan. The moment you receive the life of God through Jesus Christ, the love of God will give you all the answers you need in life.

You need to repent before God and ask Him forgiveness for blaming Him for the

evil you have seen in your life. God does not send evil to us. You need His love and life in your life. You need to start afresh with God. No more saying, "It is useless to serve God." Come to Him with a new and fresh understanding.

If you know for sure that you are a sinner and that you have not been living for God all along you need to come to Jesus today. If you know that you had just joined a church only but had no relationship with God, you need to ask Jesus to come into your life with God's kind of life right now. You need to be born again today.

Prayer Of Salvation

I want you to open your mouth and dedicate your life to Jesus by praying the following prayer. Open your mouth and out of your heart pray and say,

Dear Lord Jesus. Today I accept that you died for my sins. I accept the fact that I

am a sinner and that I need your life in me. Thank you so much for dying for my sins. I believe that you rose from the death and you are alive today. I believe that you rose with new life to give to me. Lord Jesus, I receive your life, the life of God, into my spirit. Replace my old life of sin with your new life of righteousness.

Today, I make you the Lord of my life and I thank you that I have received the life of God in me. May you show me your love and may your love heal my heart, my mind and my body. Thank you Lord for the new life that I now have. I am now righteous before God with His righteousness and not with my own. Thank you Lord.

Amen

Congratulations. You have made it to God's family. I want you to know that from today, you are now a child of God. From

today, Jesus lives in you by the Holy Spirit. Now that you have the righteousness of God, begin to show it out. Begin to live the new life that you have. Sin must not be a problem to you. The new life that you have is a life that makes it possible for you to overcome sin.

I want you to know that choosing to follow Jesus is you choosing to have upon your life the shame of following Christ. People in the world think it is foolish to be a Christian. They do not know what we have received. We do this because we love God. The devil may use friends to ridicule you because you have become a Christian. Don't mind them. You know what you have received. Treasure it and tell the world about the beauty of knowing Christ.

When we live right and tell other people about Jesus, we do this because we love God and we love the people. God loves people and He wants all of them to come to Him so that they will not go to hell. We also should love what God loves. We must aim to see God's desire accomplished

on earth as we tell the world about Jesus.

You Can Join Any Church of Your Choice

Apart from our church you can also chose to join any good church close to you. A good church is a church that preaches salvation through Jesus Christ alone. A church that teaches and believes in the Lordship of Jesus over our lives and that believes in the bible as the inspired word of God. There are so many churches like these and you should not struggle to find one that suits you.

God bless you

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